

Grid

A personal calendar system — five color-coded life circuits, a habit tracker, and an AI-driven quick-add — built to fit one specific life: college classes, irregular shift work, competitive cheer, and the habits underneath all of it.

This document is a complete record of the design decisions made and exact steps to build it, so it can be handed back to Claude later to pick up exactly where things left off.

1. The Concept

Grid runs on three pieces working together:

- **Apple Calendar** — the live, phone-native backbone. Five calendars, one per life area, each with its own color.
- **The Grid web app** — a companion page (not another calendar) for habit streaks, cheer stats, and a weekly reset ritual. Saved to the iPhone home screen.
- **The "Grid Quick Add" Shortcut** — type a plain sentence into the web app, and an on-device AI model (Apple Intelligence) parses it and writes the event directly into the correct Apple Calendar.

Visual identity

Deliberately not cheer-themed — cheer is one life area among five, not the whole brand. The look is inspired by *Tron: Legacy*: near-black background, thin glowing circuit-colored lines, sharp HUD-style panels, uppercase technical type. Each life area is a "circuit" with its own glow color.

2. The Five Circuits (Apple Calendar)

Create five calendars in Apple Calendar with these exact names (the Shortcut matches on name, so spelling must be exact) and closest available colors:

	Calendar	Color	What lives here
	Work	Blue	Shifts — irregular, communicated weekly via GroupMe, entered manually
	Cheer	Pink / Magenta	Practices and events (games, exhibitions — not competition-only)
	Classes	Purple	Fixed weekly college class schedule, recurring

Habits	Orange	Meditation, the "Learning" slot — short, flexible daily block
Personal	Green	Family, downtime, no coordination needed with anyone else

Hybrid time-blocking philosophy

- **Hard blocks** — Classes, Work shifts, and Cheer practices/events are fixed and non-negotiable.
- **Flexible slot** — Habits get a short daily block wherever the day allows; not pinned to a specific hour.
- **Open space** — everything else stays unblocked. No color, no entry, just room.

3. Habit / Streak Tracker

Lives in the Grid web app, not Apple Calendar. Style: quick daily check-off, one tap per habit, no notes.

- **Class attendance** — streak of consecutive days where every class scheduled that day was attended. Directly tied to staying on top of college attendance.
- **Meditation** — a daily mindfulness/meditation check-in streak.
- **Learning** — deliberately left as an editable, user-named slot rather than locked to one specific skill, so the focus can shift over time without rebuilding the tracker.

Streak logic: a streak increments once per day it's checked off, and resets to zero if a full day is missed. Best-streak is tracked separately and never resets.

4. Cheer Tracking

- **Season attendance** — a running count of practices + events attended this season, logged with a single tap.
- **Next cheer event countdown** — days remaining to the next event. Deliberately "event," not "competition" — events (games, exhibitions) happen more often than competitions.

A separate "current skill goal" tracker (e.g. a specific tumbling skill) was considered and explicitly removed to keep this section simple.

5. Sunday Reset Ritual

A recurring weekly checkpoint, built from two pieces:

- **The trigger** — a repeating Sunday evening event on the Personal calendar (e.g. 6pm) with a phone alert, titled "Grid — Sunday Reset."
- **The checklist** — lives in the Grid web app and auto-resets itself into a new week automatically: (1) pull next week's shifts from GroupMe and manually add them to the Work calendar — this stays manual since shifts are irregular and arrive as a personal request each week; (2) check the cheer schedule for the week; (3) review the week's streaks.

6. Quick Add — Natural Language Calendar Entry

Concept: type a plain sentence (e.g. "dentist appointment Thursday 2pm") into a command-line-style box in the Grid web app. It shows a parsed preview — action, category, date, time — for confirmation before anything is written, then hands off to write the real event.

Architecture decision

Two options were considered for how the AI parsing actually writes to Apple Calendar:

- **An Apple Shortcut** (chosen) — the web app hands the typed text to a Shortcut via the `shortcuts://` URL scheme. The Shortcut calls an AI model to parse it, then writes the event using Apple's own calendar-write action. No server to run; no credentials stored anywhere but the phone.
- A webpage + backend server — rejected for now, since it would require either storing an iCloud app-specific password on a server, or an extra manual tap to confirm via a generated calendar link.

Because the phone is an iPhone 15 Pro/16-class device on a current iOS version, Apple Intelligence's on-device Use Model Shortcuts action is available — meaning no external AI API key (Claude/OpenAI) is needed at all.

Scope note: v1 only creates new events. A sentence like "cheer practice moved to 5pm" will currently create a new event rather than reschedule the existing one — teaching it to find and edit an existing event is a natural v2, once the create-flow is confirmed working.

7. What's Already Built

Both pieces below are live, hosted pages (Claude Artifacts) — private to this account, viewable and updatable from any device, and can be added to the iPhone home screen via Safari's Share → Add to Home Screen.

Grid (the app)	https://claude.ai/code/artifact/e299e481-f5a0-4674-ae5a-f0b164077366
Grid — Setup Guide	https://claude.ai/code/artifact/f51fe0a3-d0a3-4204-9711-b3f015011e8b

Grid already works today (streaks persist on-device, calendar shows the real current month, cheer countdown is live, Sunday Reset auto-clears weekly). What's missing to make Quick Add fully functional is building the Shortcut itself — instructions below.

8. Exact Build Steps

Part 1 — The five calendars (~5 min)

1. Open the Calendar app → tap "Calendars" at the bottom → "Add Calendar..."
2. Create all five, spelled exactly: Work, Cheer, Classes, Habits, Personal.
3. Set each one's color to the closest preset match (Work=Blue, Cheer=Pink, Classes=Purple, Habits=Orange, Personal=Green). Apple's presets won't match the exact hex values used in the app — that's fine.

Part 2 — Build "Grid Quick Add" (~15–20 min)

Prerequisite: Settings → Apple Intelligence & Siri → confirm it's on and fully downloaded.

1. Shortcuts app → tap + for a new shortcut → tap the name at the top → rename it to exactly "Grid Quick Add" (must match exactly — the web app calls it by this name).
2. Add action **Current Date**.
3. Add action **Format Date**, fed from Current Date. Use a custom format including weekday, date, and time (e.g. "EEEE, MMMM d, yyyy h:mm a") so relative terms like "tomorrow" resolve correctly.
4. Add action **Use Model** (the Apple Intelligence action). In its prompt field, use the exact prompt block below — insert the Format Date variable where it says "[Current Date, formatted]", and the built-in Shortcut Input variable where it says "[Shortcut Input]".

Exact prompt for the Use Model action:

Today's date and time is [Current Date, formatted]. Read this request: "[Shortcut Input]".

Respond with exactly these four lines and nothing else, no explanation:

CALENDAR: [Work, Cheer, Classes, Habits, or Personal – whichever fits best]

TITLE: [a short, clear event title]

START: [event start as ISO 8601, e.g. 2026-08-07T17:00:00 – resolve relative dates like "tomorrow" or a weekday name using today's date above]

END: [event end as ISO 8601 – estimate a sensible duration such as 1-2 hours if none was given]

Parsing the model's output into a real event:

1. Add action **Split Text** — input: the Use Model result. Split by "New Lines." This gives a 4-item list, in order: CALENDAR, TITLE, START, END.
2. Get Item at Index 1 → Replace Text "CALENDAR: " with nothing → save as variable CalendarName.
3. Get Item at Index 2 → Replace Text "TITLE: " with nothing → save as EventTitle.
4. Get Item at Index 3 → Replace Text "START: " with nothing → Get Dates from Input → save as StartDate. Repeat for Index 4 with "END: " → EndDate.

5. Add If / Otherwise If branches on CalendarName: one branch per calendar ("contains Work" → Add New Event to Work; "contains Cheer" → Cheer; and so on through Classes, Habits, Personal), each running **Add New Event** with Title=EventTitle, Start=StartDate, End=EndDate, on that specific calendar. Final Otherwise defaults to Personal.

6. Add **Show Notification**: "Added to Grid: " + EventTitle, so there's confirmation it ran.

Part 3 — Test it

1. Open Grid on the iPhone in Safari (link above), type something in Quick Add (e.g. "dentist appointment Thursday 2pm"), tap Parse, then Confirm.
2. This should hand off to Shortcuts and run "Grid Quick Add" automatically.
3. Check Apple Calendar — the event should land on the right calendar, in the right color, at the right time.

If it fails silently, the usual culprits are a shortcut name that doesn't exactly match "Grid Quick Add," or a calendar name typo — both must match character-for-character.

9. Open Items / Next Steps

- Build and test the "Grid Quick Add" Shortcut end-to-end (this is the main remaining step).
- v2: teach Quick Add to edit or cancel existing events ("moved to 5pm"), using a "Find Calendar Events" action to locate the original first.
- Optional: a second Shortcut for fast weekly shift entry, since GroupMe schedules still require manual typing into the Work calendar.